

ACTION VERBS – FOR CV AND COVER LETTER

By using action verbs in your CV and cover letters you:

- Identify your transferable and specific skills
- Provide the employer with a clear description of what you actually accomplished or achieved
- Make your CV and application letter more professional and informative.

EXAMPLE

Instead of describing a job as: 'worked in customer service and retail sales', you could write:

- Greeted customers, explained and demonstrated benefits of products
- Contributed to meeting daily sales targets
- Handled cash, EFTPOS, cheques and credit card payments
- Don't forget to include achievements, e.g.
- Received top salesperson award 4 times in 2 years

TIP

Refer to the position description, job advertisements or employers' websites while you are preparing your CV or cover letter. Have a look at the language, verbs and terms used. Use these (in your own words) so that you communicate with the employers in the same way they communicate.

Acted	Accelerated	Accomplished	Achieved
Adapted	Addressed	Administered	Advised
Allocated	Anaylsed	Arranged	Assessed
Assigned	Attained	Attended	Broadened
Built	Budgeted	Calculated	Changed
Clarified	Classified	Coached	Communicated
Compiled	Compared	Completed	Conceived
Conducted	Counselled	Consolidated	Constructed
Controlled	Converted	Co-ordinated	Created
Customised	Defined	Delegated	Designed
Developed	Devised	Diagnosed	Directed
Distributed	Doubled	Demonstrated	Drove
Edited	Enabled	Entertained	Engineered
Exceeded	Expanded	Established	Facilitated
Forecast	Formed	Formulated	Founded
Generated	Guided	Handled	Headed
Hired	Identified	Improved	Increased
Influenced	Informed	Initiated	Inspired
Inspected	Instructed	Interpreted	Introduced
Invented	Investigated	Judged	Launched
Lectured	Led	Liaised	Managed
Marketed	Mediated	Mobilised	Moderated
Modified	Monitored	Motivated	Observed
Obtained	Opened	Operated	Ordered
Organised	Originated	Oversaw	Persuaded
Planned	Prepared	Presented	Prioritised

Prevented	Produced	Programmed	Promoted
Projected	Proposed	Provided	Publicised
Published	Purchased	Read	Recommended
Recruited	Reduced	Repaired	Reported
Researched	Resolved	Restored	Reviewed
Revitalised	Saved	Scheduled	Selected
Set	Simplified	Sold	Solved
Spoke	Staffed	Started	Strengthened
Structured	Studied	Supervised	Surveyed
Surpassed	Sustained	Tested	Trained
Transformed	Translated	Undertook	United
Upgraded	Utilised	Won	Wrote

Sample Phrases:

- Developed and implemented a marketing plan
- Prepared PowerPoint presentations and monthly reports
- Demonstrated ability to build and maintain positive working relationships
- Promoted safe work practices
- Generated templates for accounting documents
- Provided effective and timely support to IT users
- Supervised and demonstrated microbiological techniques and procedures to groups of students
- Designed and implemented an advertising campaign